CABLE TANK TOP

ENGLISH KNITTING PATTERN | WOMEN'S M & L | CHARTED TECHNICAL EDITION



SIZE	M	L
Finished chest after side seams	86.7 cm / 34.1 in	100 cm / 39.4 in
Body length	55.8 cm / 22.0 in	58.3 cm / 23.0 in
Washed gauge	18 sts x 24 rows = 10 cm	Same gauge
Construction	Worked flat; seamed; bands in the round	Same

DESIGN REFERENCE Sleeveless dark-green cable tank with ribbed lower edge, ribbed neckline and armholes, central honeycomb texture, paired diamond cables, outer rope cables, and seed-stitch side fields. Exact fit depends on washed gauge and yarn behavior.

01 SIZE, MATERIALS AND GAUGE

Choose a size from the finished measurements, not from the M/L label alone. The same 54-stitch cable panel is used in both sizes; size L gains width in the side fields.

CHECKPOINT	M	L
Cast on, each body piece	80 sts	92 sts
Side fields / centre panel	13 + 54 + 13 sts	19 + 54 + 19 sts
Piece width before seam take-up	44.4 cm / 17.5 in	51.1 cm / 20.1 in
Finished chest after side seams	86.7 cm / 34.1 in	100 cm / 39.4 in
Body length	55.8 cm / 22.0 in	58.3 cm / 23.0 in
Armhole depth	20.0 cm / 7.9 in	21.7 cm / 8.5 in
Shoulder width, each side	18 sts / 10.0 cm	22 sts / 12.2 cm
Back neck width	28 sts / 15.6 cm	32 sts / 17.8 cm
Front neck depth, approx.	10.0 cm / 3.9 in	10.8 cm / 4.3 in

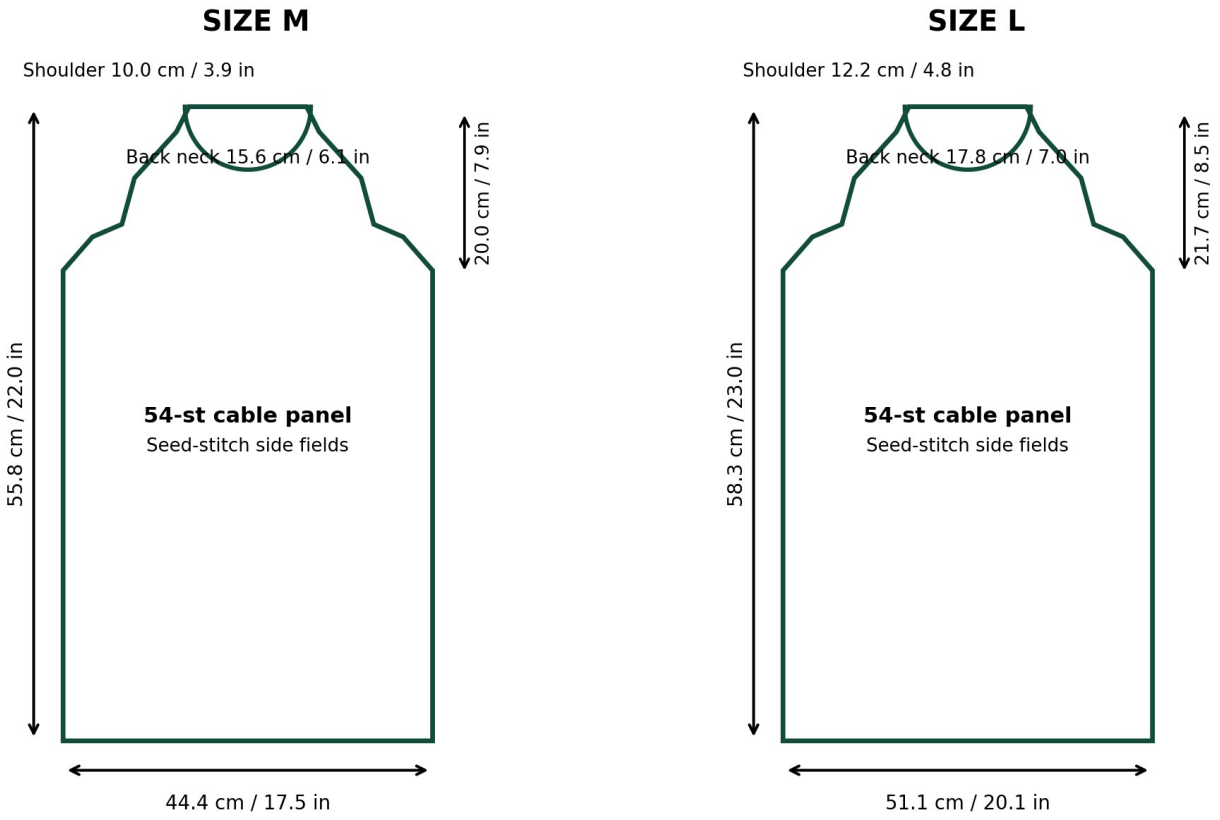
Materials

ITEM	M	L
Yarn	Approx. 900 m / 985 yd	Approx. 1050 m / 1148 yd
Yarn weight	Medium / worsted / Aran with clear cable definition	Same
Needles	4.5 mm body; 4.0 mm rib/bands recommended, or sizes needed for gauge	Same
Tools	Cable needle, markers, holders/scrap yarn, darning needle, tape measure, circular needle for bands	Same

Washed gauge - do not skip

- Work a generous swatch that includes cable texture and seed stitch. A plain stockinette swatch is not enough for this design.
- Wash and dry the swatch as you will treat the finished garment. Target 18 sts and 24 rows per 10 cm / 4 in in the representative fabric.
- Cable fabrics can contract differently from plain fabric. After the body has at least two full 16-row cable repeats, also check the actual piece width against the size table.

02 CONSTRUCTION AND ROW MAP



Front and back are worked separately from the lower hem upward. Side seams and shoulder seams are sewn after blocking. Armhole and neckline ribs are then picked up and worked in the round.

Global rows and cable rows

Global row 1 is the first rib row. The cable pattern begins on global row 13. Cable pattern row = ((global row - 13) mod 16) + 1. Keep the cable repeat running continuously through armhole shaping until a neckline removes part of a motif.

SHAPING POINT	M	L
Rib	Rows 1-12	Rows 1-12
Straight body	Rows 13-86	Rows 13-88
Armhole shaping	Rows 87-95	Rows 89-97
Front neck split	Row 111 (pattern row 3)	Row 115 (pattern row 7)
Back neck split	Row 127 (pattern row 3)	Row 133 (pattern row 9)
Shoulder bind-off	Row 135	Row 141

IMPORTANT Count global rows and cable-pattern rows separately. Shaping does not restart the 16-row cable repeat.

03 CABLE SYMBOLS AND PANEL MAP

Charts are shown as the fabric looks from the right side. Read RS chart rows from right to left and WS chart rows from left to right. On WS rows, work stitches as they appear: knit a knit-looking V and purl a purl bump. This preserves the RS texture.

p3	Rope 6	p2	Diamond 10	p2	Honeycomb 8	p2	Diamond 10	p2	Rope 6	p3
3 sts	6 sts	2 sts	10 sts	2 sts	8 sts	2 sts	10 sts	2 sts	6 sts	3 sts

Total centre panel = 54 stitches. Keep markers exactly 54 stitches apart until neckline shaping cuts into the panel.

Cable actions

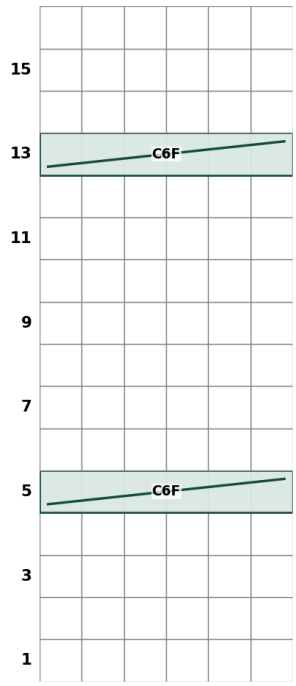
CODE	USES	EXACT ACTION
C4F	4 sts	Slip 2 sts to cable needle and hold in front; k2; k2 from cable needle.
C4B	4 sts	Slip 2 sts to cable needle and hold in back; k2; k2 from cable needle.
C6F	6 sts	Slip 3 sts to cable needle and hold in front; k3; k3 from cable needle.
T3F	3 sts	Slip 2 knit sts to cable needle and hold in front; p1; k2 from cable needle.
T3B	3 sts	Slip 1 purl st to cable needle and hold in back; k2; p1 from cable needle.

CHART KEY Blank cell = knit on RS / purl on WS. Dot = purl on RS / knit on WS. A labeled cable block replaces the cells covered by that cable crossing.

04 MOTIF CHARTS

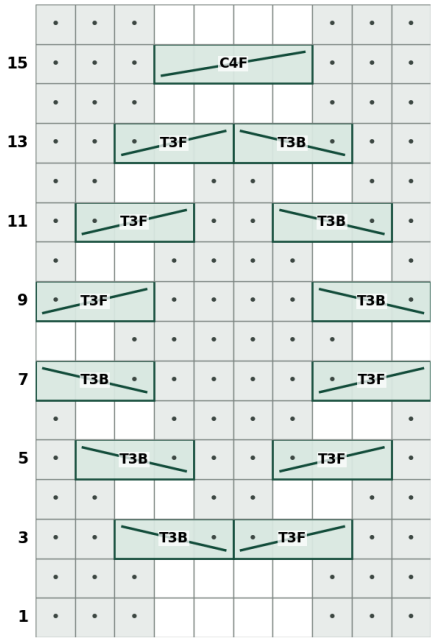
CABLE MOTIF CHARTS - 16 ROW MASTER REPEAT

ROPE 6



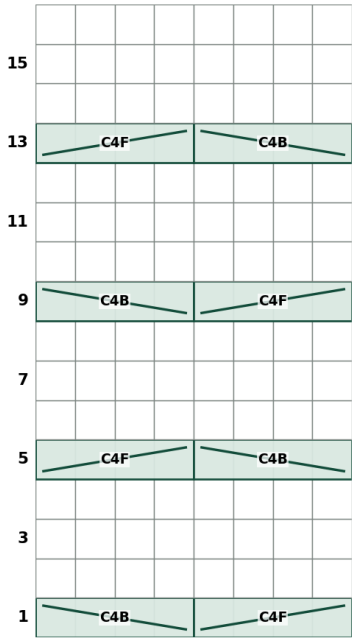
RS view

DIAMOND 10



RS view

HONEYCOMB 8



RS view

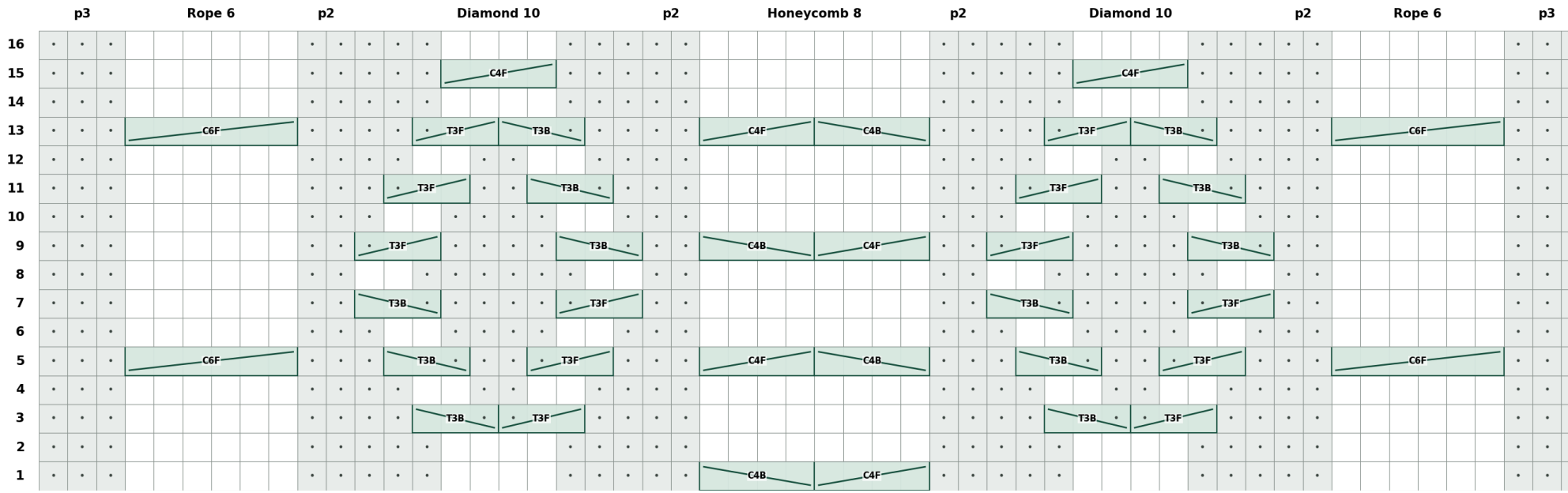
Blank = knit on RS / purl on WS • = purl on RS / knit on WS Cable labels replace the covered cells.

The Diamond 10 motif is a travelling-cable diamond. Its crossings are arranged so T3B is only worked across P-K-K and T3F only across K-K-P. This keeps the two knit strands travelling cleanly through a six-stitch purl background without changing the stitch count.

Rope 6 and Honeycomb 8 are all-knit cable fields on the RS; their WS rows are purled. Diamond background stitches remain purl on the RS and knit on the WS.

05 FULL 54-STITCH PANEL CHART

FULL 54-STITCH CABLE PANEL - CHARTED AS VIEWED FROM THE RIGHT SIDE



RS rows: read right to left. WS rows: read left to right. Blank = knit on RS / purl on WS; • = purl on RS / knit on WS.

Place a marker before and after these 54 stitches. Repeat chart rows 1-16 continuously. The separate written directions on the next page match this chart row-for-row.

06 WRITTEN 54-STITCH PANEL INSTRUCTIONS

On every RS row, work the panel in this fixed order: p3 | Rope 6 | p2 | Diamond 10 | p2 | Honeycomb 8 | p2 | Diamond 10 | p2 | Rope 6 | p3.

PATTERN ROW	ROPE 6 - EACH	DIAMOND 10 - EACH	HONEYCOMB 8
1	k6	p3, k4, p3	C4B, C4F
3	k6	p2, T3B, T3F, p2	k8
5	C6F	p1, T3B, p2, T3F, p1	C4F, C4B
7	k6	T3B, p4, T3F	k8
9	k6	T3F, p4, T3B	C4B, C4F
11	k6	p1, T3F, p2, T3B, p1	k8
13	C6F	p2, T3F, T3B, p2	C4F, C4B
15	k6	p3, C4F, p3	k8

Even pattern rows 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12, 14 and 16

Work stitches exactly as they appear on the WS: knit the stitches that look like knit Vs and purl the stitches that look like purl bumps. In practical terms, Rope and Honeycomb are purled across on WS rows; Diamond knit strands are purled and its purl background is knitted.

NECKLINE RULE Never work a cable crossing unless all stitches required for that crossing are still present. When a neckline removes part of a motif, stop crossing that partial motif and work its surviving stitches in their established knit/purl texture. Continue any complete motif normally.

07 HEM AND STRAIGHT BODY - FRONT AND BACK

Rows 1-12: lower rib

CO 80 sts for M or 92 sts for L. Row 1 (RS): *k2, p2; repeat from * to end. Rows 2-12: work the rib as established - knit the knit stitches and purl the purl stitches as they appear. Do not alternate the rib sequence by row.

Row 13 (RS): establish the body pattern

SIZE	LEFT SIDE - PANEL - RIGHT SIDE	TOTAL
M	k1 selvedge, 12 seed sts, marker, 54-st panel, marker, 12 seed sts, k1 selvedge	80 sts
L	k1 selvedge, 18 seed sts, marker, 54-st panel, marker, 18 seed sts, k1 selvedge	92 sts

Seed-stitch side fields

- On the first RS body row, after the left selvedge work (k1, p1) across the left seed field. After the panel, work the right seed field as (p1, k1). This mirrors the texture at the panel edges.
- On following rows, maintain seed stitch by working the opposite of the stitch you see: purl a knit-looking V and knit a purl bump. Work the outer selvedge stitch in stockinette: knit on RS, purl on WS.
- Keep the two panel markers 54 stitches apart. Armhole shaping removes only side-field stitches, so the cable panel remains intact until neckline shaping.

Work straight

M: work through global row 86; 80 sts remain. L: work through global row 88; 92 sts remain. The last straight-body row is a WS row in both sizes.

CHECKPOINT Before beginning armholes, verify the total stitch count, 54 stitches between the panel markers, and the cable-pattern row phase.

08 BACK - ARMHOLES, NECK AND SHOULDERS

ACTION	M	L
First armhole row, RS	Row 87: BO 4 at row start; 76 sts remain	Row 89: BO 4 at row start; 88 sts remain
Next row, WS	Row 88: BO 4 at row start; 72 sts remain	Row 90: BO 4 at row start; 84 sts remain
4 RS decrease rows	Rows 89,91,93,95: dec 1 at EACH edge -> 70,68,66,64 sts	Rows 91,93,95,97: dec 1 at EACH edge -> 82,80,78,76 sts
Work even	Rows 96-126 on 64 sts	Rows 98-132 on 76 sts
Back neck split, RS	Row 127: work 18; place these 18 on holder; BO centre 28; work to end - 18 sts remain	Row 133: work 22; place these 22 on holder; BO centre 32; work to end - 22 sts remain
Shoulders	Work each shoulder through row 134; BO 18 sts on row 135	Work each shoulder through row 140; BO 22 sts on row 141

Armhole decreases

On each listed RS decrease row: k1, ssk; maintain the remaining seed field; work the complete 54-st panel; maintain the opposite side seed field to the last 3 sts; k2tog, k1. Each decrease row removes exactly 2 stitches. Work every intervening WS row without decreases.

Working the two back shoulders

After the centre neck bind-off, continue the second shoulder first. Work its next row as the required WS row and continue to the listed final WS row, then bind off on the following RS row. Rejoin yarn at the neck edge of the held first shoulder and work the same row numbers so both shoulder tops finish at exactly the same height.

PARTIAL MOTIFS If the back neck cuts into a Diamond motif, do not force a T3 or C4 crossing across missing stitches. Work the remaining stitches in their established knit/purl texture until the shoulder bind-off.

09 FRONT - NECKLINE AND SHOULDERS

Work the front exactly as the back through completion of armhole shaping. The front neckline starts earlier.

ACTION	M	L
After armhole shaping	64 sts after row 95	76 sts after row 97
Work even	Rows 96-110	Rows 98-114
Front neck split, RS	Row 111: work 22; place on holder; BO centre 20; work to end - 22 sts remain	Row 115: work 26; place on holder; BO centre 24; work to end - 26 sts remain
Neck decreases	Rows 113,115,117,119: dec 1 at neck edge -> 21,20,19,18 sts	Rows 117,119,121,123: dec 1 at neck edge -> 25,24,23,22 sts
Finish	Keep 18 sts through row 134; BO row 135	Keep 22 sts through row 140; BO row 141

Mirror-image neck decreases

- Second shoulder (worked after the centre BO): its RS rows begin at the neckline. Work k1, ssk, then continue in established pattern to the outer edge.
- First shoulder (held before the centre BO): rejoin yarn at the neckline for the next WS row. On each listed RS row, work from the outer edge to the last 3 sts, then k2tog, k1.
- Work all intervening WS rows without a decrease. Stop after the fourth neck decrease. Final shoulder counts must be 18 sts each for M or 22 sts each for L.

CABLES AT THE FRONT NECK As soon as a neckline removes part of a Diamond or other cable group, stop crossings in that incomplete group. Preserve the knit/purl columns that remain. Complete Rope or other full cable groups may continue normally.

10 FINISHING AND RIBBED BANDS

Blocking and seams

- Wet-block front and back separately to the target measurements. Let both pieces dry completely before seaming.
- Sew shoulder bound-off edges with a firm backstitch seam, right sides together. Match the front and back shoulder row ends exactly.
- Sew side seams with mattress stitch, one full stitch in from the edge. Match global rows so the cable columns and lower rib remain level.

Armhole bands

	M	L
Target pickup	80 sts around EACH armhole	88 sts around EACH armhole
Guide per half	4 sts across underarm BO + about 36 along shaped/vertical edge	4 sts across underarm BO + about 40 along shaped/vertical edge

With RS facing and the smaller circular needle, begin at the underarm seam. Distribute pickups smoothly to the shoulder seam and mirror them on the second half. Confirm the total before knitting the rib.

Neckline band - revised pickup counts

	M - 92 sts total	L - 104 sts total
Horizontal edges	Back 28 + front centre 20	Back 32 + front centre 24
Shaped/vertical edges	5 along each back-neck side + 17 along each front-neck slope	5 along each back-neck side + 19 along each front-neck slope

Horizontal bound-off edges are picked up approximately 1 stitch per bound-off stitch. Along row-end edges, distribute approximately 3 stitches for every 4 rows. The totals above are multiples of 4 for the 2x2 rib and are matched to the stated 18-st / 24-row gauge.

Ribbing

For both armholes and neckline: with RS facing, work 6 rounds of *k2, p2; repeat from * around. Bind off loosely in pattern. If a band visibly pulls inward or flares after a trial round, redistribute the pickups and adjust the total by a multiple of 4 rather than forcing the edge flat during blocking.

11 QUALITY-CONTROL CHECKLIST

CHECKPOINT	M TARGET	L TARGET
After rib, global row 12	80 sts	92 sts
After both underarm BO rows	72 sts at row 88	84 sts at row 90
After last armhole decrease	64 sts at row 95	76 sts at row 97
Front immediately after neck split	22 / 20 BO / 22	26 / 24 BO / 26
Front after 4 neck decreases	18 each shoulder	22 each shoulder
Back immediately after neck split	18 / 28 BO / 18	22 / 32 BO / 22
Armhole pickup target	80 per opening	88 per opening
Neckline pickup target	92 total	104 total

Cable audit checkpoints

- Every centre panel row uses exactly 54 stitches. Cable crossings rearrange stitches but never increase or decrease the panel count.
- Diamond 10 always contains four travelling knit stitches and six purl-background stitches. T3B must meet P-K-K; T3F must meet K-K-P. If that setup is not present, stop and correct the previous cable row.
- Rope 6 and Honeycomb 8 contain only knit stitches on the RS. On WS rows these fields are purled.
- Front and back shoulder counts and final row numbers must match before seaming: M = 18 sts and row 135; L = 22 sts and row 141.

Problem solving

- Cable panel count is wrong: undo to the last incorrect crossing. Do not repair a cable-count problem by adding an unlisted increase.
- Front and back do not align: compare global row number and cable-repeat phase before seaming.
- Finished garment is too narrow or wide: compare the washed gauge and actual piece width before changing stitch counts.
- Rib band ripples or pulls: redistribute pickup spacing and, if necessary, change the total by a multiple of 4.

SUPPORT If a step is unclear, message the seller with the size, section title, global row number, current stitch count and a clear photo of the work. This makes troubleshooting much faster.

PERSONAL USE: Finished garments may be sold in small quantities. Please do not redistribute, translate, share or resell the PDF instructions.